

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

K	N	E	W
S	T	O	P

Ladder 2

R	E	A	D
W	E	N	T

Ladder 3

F	I	L	L
S	A	V	E

Ladder 4

M	E	A	T
T	O	L	D

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

K	N	E	W
K	N	O	W
S	N	O	W
S	H	O	W
S	H	O	P
S	T	O	P

Ladder 2

R	E	A	D
R	E	A	L
S	E	A	L
S	E	A	T
S	E	N	T
W	E	N	T

Ladder 3

F	I	L	L
F	A	L	L
T	A	L	L
T	A	L	E
S	A	L	E
S	A	V	E

Ladder 4

M	E	A	T
B	E	A	T
B	O	A	T
B	O	L	T
B	O	L	D
T	O	L	D